

ACTIVITY 10 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**MoSCoW, Kano and the Product Backlog**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Workshop	90 minutes	LO1	3 - Plan the Project

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to apply MoSCoW with the discipline rules that make it a prioritisation tool rather than a labelling exercise.

What learners produce

moscow, kano, product backlog — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- The Project Management Templates pack (see the Activities folder)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- Laptop with internet access for the live problem-solving tools
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 to 4. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group; each group needs one laptop for the calculations.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Apply MoSCoW to the Lab 09 requirements. Create artifacts/10-moscow.md. Test every candidate Must against the three-part question before accepting it.	Watch for groups listing only the obvious. Ask what they are deliberately leaving out, and why.
2	Classify the features on Kano. Create artifacts/10-kano.md. Classify by asking the Kano pair of questions for each feature: how would you feel if the feature were present, and how would you feel if it were absent.	Insist on individual listing before pooling, or the loudest voice sets the whole list.
3	Where MoSCoW and Kano disagree, and why that is useful. Running both models produces conflicts. The conflicts are the point; if the two models agreed everywhere, one of them would be redundant.	Debrief on what was conceded and why — the trade, not the outcome, is the learning.

4	Write the product backlog. Create artifacts/10-product-backlog.md. Every story uses the form: As a <role>, I want <capability>, so that <benefit>. The "so that" clause is not decoration - a story whose benefit clause cannot be completed is a story with no traceable value, and Lab 09's backward traceability would flag it as gold plating.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
5	Estimate with story points, not hours	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
6	Build the release plan against real capacity. Create artifacts/10-release-plan.md. Sequence by dependency and by gate obligation, not by preference.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
7	Make the AI recommender trade-off numeric. Lab 07 identified misalignment M-1 and committed you to converting an argument about importance into a concrete trade-off. Here is the arithmetic that session needs.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
8	Answer the exam-style scenarios	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
9 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
33 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
34 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
14 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 90 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Apply MoSCoW with the discipline rules that make it a prioritisation tool rather than a labelling exercise — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Apply the Kano model and understand why customer satisfaction is not linear with functionality — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Use the productive disagreement between MoSCoW and Kano to find the requirements both would have got wrong alone — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. Every Must in your backlog passes at least one leg of the three-part test, and you can say which leg. "The sponsor wants it" appears nowhere as a justification — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would moscow, kano and the product backlog have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- Every Must in your backlog passes at least one leg of the three-part test, and you can say which leg. "The sponsor wants it" appears nowhere as a justification.
- Your Must effort share is at or below 60% and you computed it rather than assumed it.
- Your Kano classification includes at least one Reverse feature, and the backlog item arising from it is a removal rather than an addition.

- You identified at least one genuine disagreement between MoSCoW and Kano and explained why it is productive rather than an error.
- Every story has a "so that" clause naming a real benefit. A story whose benefit clause is "so that the system works" has no value statement.
- No story larger than 21 points is scheduled into a sprint without being split first.
- Your rebalanced release plan has no sprint above 34 points. If any sprint exceeds capacity, the plan is arithmetic fiction.
- You proved the Must-haves fit before G2 with a number - capacity to sprint 9 versus Must effort - not with an assurance.